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In Clemency Inquiry, 'Pro' Proves Elusive

■ Clinton: There's a 'quid,' legal experts say, and maybe even a 'quo.' But finding a link could be impossible.

By STEPHEN BRAUN
and RICHARD A. SERRANO
TIMES STAFF WRITERS

NEW YORK—Two months after Bill Clinton departed the nation's capital, the scandal he left behind has followed him here.

The political controversy surrounding the former president's eleven-hour clemencies has all but played out in Washington, where congressional hearings featured a parade of former White House aides who acknowledged that they and even Clinton erred in rushing through the clemency process, swayed by influential friends and relatives.

The central mystery behind Clinton's 177 last-minute pardons and commutations—whether they were exchanged for money or other

favorites—now is the subject of a criminal investigation led by Mary Jo White, the U.S. attorney in New York.

But New York-based federal prosecutors and FBI agents are chasing the same slippery target that has eluded congressional investigators: overwhelming proof that crimes were committed. Former prosecutors, legal experts and political observers say that task may prove too daunting even for White's resourceful team of investigators. Allegations that federal laws may have been broken remain hazy and distant, and evidence is slim.

"It seems pretty clear from what we know so far that there was a quid here and probably even a quo," said Jan W. Baran, a former counsel for the Republican National Committee. "The problem is, no one seems to have found the pro yet."

The likelihood that criminal charges will be leveled against the former president, other Clinton administration officials or private individuals is remote, say those familiar with such politically charged investigations.

A more probable end, many suggest, is that White's probe will proceed quietly for several months, amassing voluminous evidence. Charges may be brought against "those lower in the food chain," one former prosecutor said. But many observers expect that the investigation will end with a simple announcement of closure.

"My prediction is that nothing other than a grand jury investigation will come of this," said Washington attorney Pam Stuart, a former Clinton Justice Department official who now works as a criminal defense lawyer.

White, a Clinton appointee who **Please see PROBE, A20**

Associated Press
U.S. Atty. Mary Jo White of New York has been authorized to look into all of former President Clinton's last-minute clemencies.

An Extraordinary Gift, Given Without Strings, to a Stranger

■ Transplant: Inspired by a magazine story, a woman gave away a kidney. Now she will meet the recipient.

By KIMI YOSHINO
TIMES STAFF WRITER

For a couple of hours, Terry Rose lay just an operating room away from the man who would receive her kidney.

He was a total stranger then. He still is.

And Rose, well, she is one of a tiny group of extraordinary people who take philanthropy to a new level. The 47-year-old Newport Beach woman decided one day to give away her kidney, because, she points out, she needs only one.

She didn't care who got it, as long as it did some good.

Family and friends were astounded by her decision, prompted by an article in People magazine about a North Carolina schoolteacher who donated a kidney to a student.

That's how it routinely works: A kidney goes to a friend or co-worker, a mother or sibling, but hardly ever to a stranger. Last year, there might have been 30 cases nationwide involving living anonymous donors.

Rose, who is single, doesn't quite understand the commotion.

"To me, it's no big deal," she said. "It's like giving a part of blood."

On Tuesday, the transplant team at UC Irvine Medical Center in Orange will help Rose come face to face with her mystery man, the 28-year-old from Westminster who waited nearly four years for a kidney. Now he has three—two shrunken, silver "jacks" donated by Rose, who is single, doesn't quite understand the commotion.

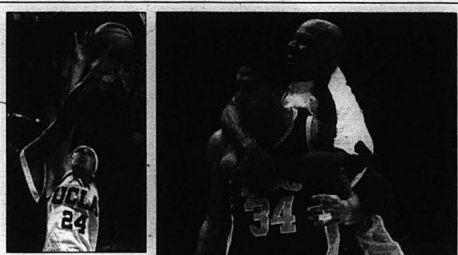
She will see his healthy glow, his easy walk, no longer sluggish. She will ask the questions she's been eager to ask: How are you? Who are

you? How is life different? And though she admits to being a little reserved, she might even hug him.

She wants to be sure, she joked, that the mother man isn't rejecting her.

The stranger, now healthy and happily planning his future, has a few excited questions of his own, including one that rises above all others: Why?

Their meeting is just a couple of days away, a wait that is nothing new for Rose. **Please see KIDNEY, A20**



ROBERT GAUTHER / Los Angeles Times

Two Sweet

For the first time, UCLA and USC matched basketball's Sweet 16 in the same year by defeating their second-round tournament opponents. Jason Kapono, working inside, above, scored 19 points to help lead the Bruins past Utah State, 75-50, in Greensboro, N.C. The Trojans' Brandon Granville, right, leaps on teammate David Bluthenthal in celebration after USC edged Boston College, 74-71, in Uniondale, N.Y. UCLA plays Duke next, while the Trojans have a contest with Kentucky. **Complete coverage, S1**



GINA PIRAZZI / Los Angeles Times

Despite Sub Probe, Military Quietly Revives VIP Tours

By PAUL RICHTER
TIMES STAFF WRITER

WASHINGTON—Five weeks after a U.S. submarine struck and sank a Japanese tanker off Hawaii, the presence of 16 civilian VIPs on the craft remains a point of controversy and a focus of an official Navy investigation.

But on Monday, a group of freshmen lawmakers from the U.S. House will climb aboard a sub in Florida's Port Everglades for eight hours of instruction and excitement—just the sort of thing that had been planned for visitors on the sub Greenview before its deadly Feb. 9 collision.

The Distinguished Visitors Program has quietly come back because—bad publicity or no—it's simply too important to the military to give up.

Because the sub accident raised questions about whether visitors hampered the crew's work, VIPs can no longer take half of the con-

Please see MILITARY, A14

Charter School's Scores Up, So Why Is Board Unhappy?

■ Education: Debate over a firm running a San Francisco school that once performed poorly touches on basic issues

By MARIA L. LA GANZA
TIMES STAFF WRITER

SAN FRANCISCO—What's wrong with this picture? The children at Edison Charter Academy—formerly one of this city's most notorious schools—are learning to read and do math. Their test scores began to improve. Their parents are delighted.

But the board of education, here in the nation's most ideological city, wants to kick out the for-profit corporation that has run the campus for the past three years: Edison Schools Inc., which vowed at its birth to revolutionize education in America.

Critics of the school board argue that the officials are on an ideological jihad against school privatization.

Critics of Edison call the academic improvement a sham and claim that any school would do better if it got

more money and could weed out its most challenging students.

The controversy comes at a critical time for the company, which runs 113 schools across the country and trades as EDSN on the Nasdaq stock exchange. With San Francisco poised to become the first city in the nation to show Edison the door, parents in New York City began voting today on whether to allow the company to run five of that city's low-performing schools.

The board of education here has begun investigating a range of charges against the company, including allegations that the Edison Charter Academy diverts special education students to other campuses, that its original charter may be illegal and that it has not provided adequate financial information to the school district.

The board could move as soon as **Please see SCHOOL, A28**

SUNDAY REPORT



The Sierra Club's Nelson Ho visits a shrine on Mauna Kea, left. At right, technicians clean mirrors on Keck II telescope.

Science, Culture Clash Over Sacred Mountain

By USHA LEE McFARLING
TIMES STAFF WRITER

MAUNA KEA—When Ed Stevens drives the dusty track to this wind-swept summit atop Hawaii's Big Island, he tries hard not to see the gleaming white and silver telescopes that dot the landscape. He doesn't want to see the starkly stark, almost white, volcanic red rock.

He tries not to see where precious cinder cones—home to goddesses—were flattened and

paved for the hulking Western machines. He tries not to see a blindingly white radio antenna dish within a stone's throw of an ancient rock shrine that resembles Stonehenge.

"I go up there and I don't see them. Because if I see them I get angry," said Stevens, 70, who regularly drives two hours from his house in Kona to worship at Mauna Kea. In the naturalistic religion of Hawaiians, Mauna Kea—the White Moun-

tain—is the highest temple in Polynesia, where, amid the snow, Hawaiians placed shrines and practiced burial rituals so secret that it is taboo to speak of them to outsiders.

But he can't ignore the newcomers completely. "You hear this humming," he said. "It's so intrusive when you are trying to commune with these entities. These benefactors."

The mountain is equally sacred to astronomers: With its

astoundingly clear, clear and dark skies, it is the best place on the planet to view the universe. This desolate peak holds the world's densest concentration of telescopes: 13, including the world's two largest.

When the first telescopes rose from the mountain—one a year in 1968, 1969 and 1970—there was not a peep of dissent from Hawaiians. Thirty years and nearly \$1 billion worth of

Please see CLASH, A16

Massive Spy-Satellite Program to Cost Billions

■ Aerospace: Southland firms will get a major boost from top-secret, two-decade effort. Its scope could dwarf the Manhattan Project.

By PETER PAE
TIMES STAFF WRITER

A team of Southern California aerospace companies is covertly recruiting engineers across the country for a new generation of spy satellites under what analysts believe is the largest intelligence-related contract ever.

The supersized project for the National Reconnaissance Office is estimated to be worth up to \$25 billion over two decades, providing a major boost to the Southland's aerospace industry and solidifying the area's dominance of high-tech space research.

Equipped with powerful telescopes and radar, the nation's newest eye in space is expected to form the backbone of U.S. intelligence for several decades, analysts said. The satellites will be farther out in space and harder to detect than the massive spy probes that currently orbit the Earth. They will also be able to fly over and take pictures of military compounds anywhere in the world, in darkness or through cloud cover, with far more frequency.

Company officials are restricted from talking about the highly classified contract, but Roger Roberts, general manager of the Boeing Co. unit in Seal Beach overseeing the project, gave a hint of its scope.

The program will require 5,000 engineers, technicians and computer programmers over the next five years, and that will just be for initial design and development of the satellites, he said.

That figure doesn't include thousands more who will be required to build the satellites, most likely at Boeing Satellite Systems in El Segundo. **Please see SPY, A36**

Mexican Envoy Seeks to Forge U.S.-Cuba Ties

By MARK FINEMAN
TIMES STAFF WRITER

HAVANA—In the two months since Ricardo Pascoe arrived here as Mexico's ambassador to Cuba, he has met with President Fidel Castro nearly a dozen times, briefed visiting U.S. intelligence officials and negotiated multimillion-dollar trade deals with the Communist nation.

And he received just one death threat.

After all, he will not only be the point man in trying to restore his official ties between Mexico-Cuba relations but will also serve as an ideological translator for the United States and Cuba in an attempt to bridge four decades of Cold War animosity.

The blue-eyed 50-year-old is a man of great complexity and accustomed with conflict. He's a former Trotskyite and political prisoner and an architect of Mexico's modern political left, but he owes his job to Mexico's new center-right president, Vicente Fox. His appointment in December triggered a furious 10-hour debate within the opposition party he co-founded, the leftist Democratic Revolution Party.

Although he earned a practical doctorate from the London School of Economics, he has also received a more ethereal philosophy degree from New York University. **Please see CUBA, A9**

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SO CALLING Rampart's Aftermath

The city's payouts resulting from the Rampart police scandal are affecting victims, police and the community in unexpected ways. **E1**

TRAVEL A Paddler's View of Alaska

Cruising on a small ship equipped with kayaks is the way to get up close and personal with Glacier Bay's flora, fauna and fjords. **L1**

METRO Tug of War Over Race Car

A rare Cobra Daytona coupe worth millions turned up after the death of its owner, setting off a legal battle among family and friends. **B1**

REAL ESTATE Rethinking Realty Charges

Realty commissions are changing with "fee for services" plans, where buyers and sellers save by doing things themselves. **K1**

Weather: Mostly sunny today after patchy morning fog. Downtown: 80/51, 84

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METRO

Los Angeles Times

Educators
Hear Tips
on Averting
Violence

■ **Schools:** L.A. Unified counselors and police are urged to avoid knee-jerk reactions and learn to distinguish serious threats from idle talk.

By NOAMI SCHWARTZ
TIMES STAFF WRITER

Citing recent incidents in which officials have punished students for making violent comments, a Los Angeles Police Department psychologist said Saturday that educators need to learn the difference between a serious threat and an immature comment.

Talking to a group of 200 Los Angeles Unified School District counselors and on-campus police officers who gathered for a workshop on assessing and responding to threats, Kris Mordike cautioned administrators about knee-jerk reactions that lead to unnecessary expulsions.

"All threats are not created equal," he said, illustrating his point with a recent Pasadena incident that he called an overreaction. "Sure you need to investigate," he said, "but what people have to do is think about what is the context."

Last week, a Pasadena high school senior was jailed after another student reportedly overheard the 18-year-old say he hated school and wanted to blow it up. The accused student, who is still in custody, says it was a joke.

Since a deadly high school shooting in Santee that left two dead and 13 injured March 5, at least 12 students in Southern California have been arrested on suspicion of making threats at school or to their classmates.

A 15-year-old Van Nuys boy who allegedly threatened on the Internet to kill at least 75 of his classmates was charged Friday with three felony counts of making terrorist threats.

A Thousand Oaks middle school student was arrested for allegedly compiling an online hit list, and an Orange County student was picked up for allegedly making a threat that prompted nearly 2,000 students to stay home.

A 16-year-old student at Landmark Christian School was arrested Thursday on suspicion of making terrorist threats after allegedly said he was going to kill his mother and other students, Lancaster authorities said.

Saturday's session was part of a larger effort by L.A. Unified to make schools safer. Using \$4.3 million in state funds earmarked to curb school violence, the district workshops, which started this month, train counselors and on-campus officials.

"Crisis management teams" made up of those who are trained will deal with potential threats in elementary, middle and high school. Director of School Operations Willie Crittendon said he hopes to have the teams in place before June.

On Saturday, Mohandine showed films, including one of a teenage school shooter, cited historical examples of school violence dating back to 1927, and passed out a 45-page book outlining how to manage school violence. He repeatedly

Please see SCHOOLS, B7

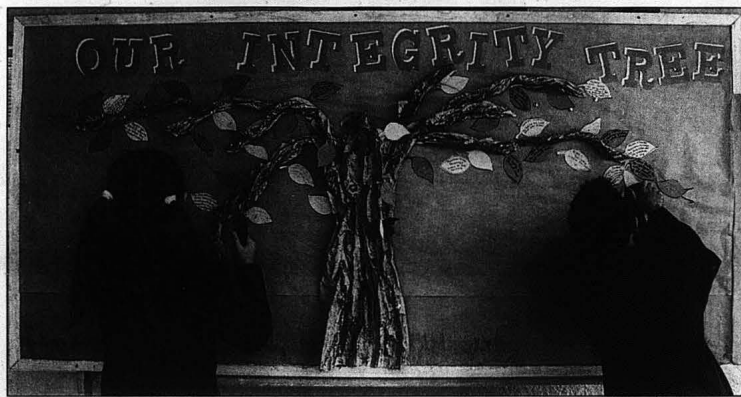


Photo by ANNIE WELLS / Los Angeles Times

Making Courtesy
Common

■ **Education:** As school violence puts spotlight on values, one San Gabriel campus reflects a growing push to teach civility along with academics.

By MARTHA GROVES
TIMES EDUCATION WRITER

When Kathy Perin became principal of Emperor Elementary School eight years ago, teachers peppered her with complaints about ill-behaved, unkind students.

These days, courteous sixth-graders at the San Gabriel cafeteria to clean up the cafeteria and teach computer skills to younger pupils. Teachers fashion "integrity trees" to honor students' good deeds. And youngsters formally pledge to show respect and compassion for others.

What made the difference was Values in Action, a character education program that teaches seven core ethical values, including responsibility and perseverance.



Emperor Elementary sixth-graders Stacy Annas, left, and Britnee Larson help first-grader Bobbie Williams with her reading.

As educators and parents in the past decade have grappled with the whys of school violence

and discipline problems, the teaching of values and moral principles in schools has surged in popularity.

The push—endorsed by President Bush—is coming amid what many parents, educators and politicians perceive as the collapse of common courtesy and decency in society at large. Events such as the March 5 shooting at Santana High School in suburban San Diego and the recent shutdown of SchoolRumors.com, a Web site where Southland students used explicit language to insult one another, bring the problem into sharp focus.

At least 48 states, California among them, have embraced educational standards for teaching character to students.

In a 1996 survey by the National School Boards Assn., more than three-quarters of all districts said they had adopted or planned to adopt a character

education initiative. Nationwide, more than 150 independent centers, including several in California, peddle such materials and programs.

Bush, a key proponent, advocates tripling the nearly \$9 million in federal funds that schools spend annually on character education.

Yet detractors on the political right see character education as an attempt by schools to override the responsibilities of parents and churches.

Left-leaning critics, meanwhile, worry that some programs—notably Character First, run out of Oklahoma City—flirt with evangelism and excessively stress obedience to authority figures.

"Most of the programs people are nervous about go up to the line with an approach that is too authoritarian or perhaps reflects one religion," said Charles Haynes, senior scholar at the First Amendment Center of the Freedom Forum, a research group in Arlington, Va. But most programs, he noted, are careful to avoid overt references to religion, thereby steering clear of

Please see VALUES, B7

Precinct Walkers Hit Streets
in Effort to Persuade Voters
to Vote for Villaraigosa

■ **Elections:** Democratic Party volunteers and union workers enlisted by the county Federation of Labor begin door-to-door effort for the mayoral candidate.

By MATTEA GOLD
TIMES STAFF WRITER

In one of the first significant deployments of ground troops in the Los Angeles mayor's race, hundreds of union members and Democratic Party volunteers hit the streets Saturday, kicking off a massive door-to-door effort to elect former Assembly Speaker Antonio Villaraigosa.

Fueled by coffee and chants of "Si se puede!" the volunteers fanned out across the Eastside and the San Fernando Valley. Their goal: to turn out at least 50,000 voters for the election.

The all-out effort for Villaraigosa is the payoff for winning the sought-after endorsements of the Los Angeles County Federation of Labor and the Democratic Party,

organizations that are combining their financial resources and manpower to win him votes.

Labor's ability to deliver, however, remains unproved. Local unions have delivered important support for local candidates in recent elections, but have yet to show that they can win a citywide race.

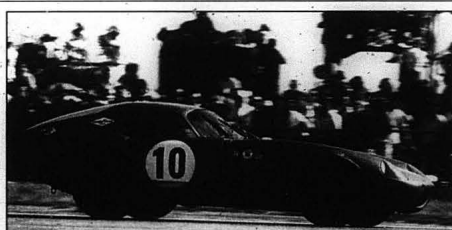
"At the end of the day, it's going to be a very competitive race on the airwaves," said federation head Miguel Contreras. "What's going to make the difference for Antonio is the people power."

Under the direction of the federation, the labor unions are focusing their efforts on likely union voters in the Valley and the Westside, a \$1-million push that will involve visits to about 70,000 homes, phone calls to about 250,000, and six to eight mailers during the next three weeks, Contreras said.

The state Democratic Party, meanwhile, has hired veteran union organizers to target Latino Democratic voters on the Eastside and in the Valley, hoping to have hundreds of volunteers on the streets daily in places like Highland Park, Pico-Union and Pacoima.

The drive to win over Latino voters highlights Villaraigosa's need to secure a voting base in that community, even as he has tried to create a multiethnic coalition of support. So far, Villaraigosa is still trying to demonstrate that he can

Please see WALKERS, B2



The Cobra Daytona coupe brakes for a curve at Sebring, Fla., during its racing days in 1964.

Cobra Conundrum
Long-Lost Race Car Is the Prize in a Tug of War

By SCOTT MARTELE
TIMES STAFF WRITER

About the only fact that friends and relatives of Donna O'Hara can agree on is that she's dead. And that a dented blue Cobra Daytona coupe race car that the Sears shop worker had hidden away for nearly three decades is worth a lot more than it looks.

Somewhere around \$4 million, in fact.

But that's where the agreements end. And the squabbling begins.

In the five months since O'Hara, 86, burned herself to death on a Fullerton horse trail,

her friends and relatives have become embroiled in a bitter lawsuit over rival claims to the rare 1964 race car once owned by reclusive music producer Phil Spector.

The dispute includes allegations of a stolen document and lies told of duplicity and a secret plan in February that sent the car to a private collection in Philadelphia—a distressing development for a nationwide circle of car buffs and high-end collectors enthralled by the discovery of a machine long believed lost.

"The car's been missing for 30 years," said Lynn Park, a Cobra collector from La Caliente, Plindridge who once tried to find the

vehicle, known to collectors as the CSX287. "A lot of people have tried and it was still missing. When it surfaced, it was quite something."

The story of the missing Cobra, and of the legal fight that has erupted in the wake of O'Hara's suicide, has more twists and turns than a grand prize race course, its arcane details hard to follow and, at times, hard to believe.

"I am going to challenge all of you and ask if you are not making this up," Orange County Superior Court Judge James P. Gray told an array of lawyers who filed into his courtroom March 6 for a hearing.

Please see COBRA, B5

INSIDE

PIER PRESSURE: Two years after a Laguna Beach pier was demolished, many like the beach without one. B3

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METRO NEWS

Storm-Ravaged Pier Might Not Be Replaced After All

■ **Beach:** Officials promised to rebuild the Aliso Pier after storms and work crews had knocked it down. Now, many would prefer to keep the shoreline and its views uncluttered.

By STANLEY ALLISON
TIMES STAFF WRITER

LAGUNA BEACH—When wrecking crews demolished the Aliso Pier in the wake of several damaging El Niño storms, residents in south Laguna took comfort in the promises from county officials that they would eventually rebuild the landmark fishing pier.

But two years later, efforts to construct a new pier have stalled, with many beach denizens as well as county leaders concluding that the beach is actually better without one.

For residents who live on the bluffs above the beach, the now-uninterrupted view of the ocean cove is more pleasing than the decidedly minimalist 660-foot concrete pier with its distinctive diamond-shaped end.

And that's just as well, because the county has found that rebuilding the structure would be difficult if not impossible.

A pier at that location is simply a bad idea, engineers have told county officials. The unusual landscape beneath the water's surface causes waves to surge from various directions, putting extreme stress on any structure built in the zone.

The wave action would prohibit the type of concrete and steel structure of the original pier, said Supervisor Tom Wilson, who represents the area.

Twice in its 28 years, the pier had to be repaired after El Niño storms caused extensive damage. History would just repeat itself, Wilson said, if another concrete and steel pier were built.

The only way to ensure that it would last, he said, would be to use wood.

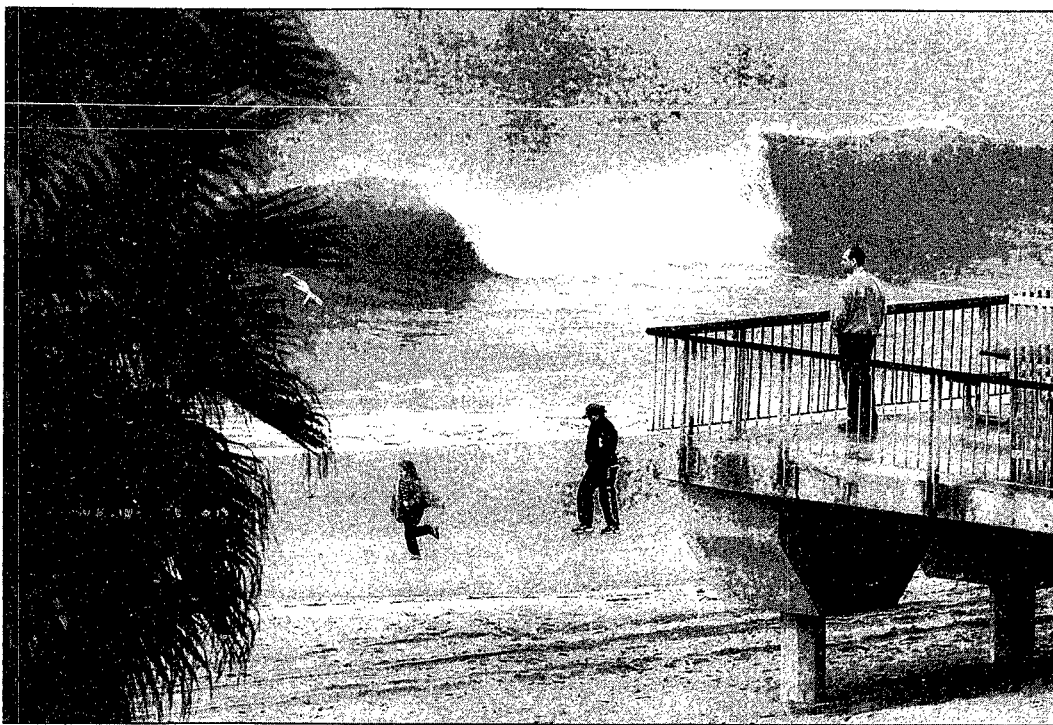
But that would require massive sequoia trees, about 100 feet long, as pilings in the ocean floor. Unlike concrete and steel, wood pilings bend and have a better chance of withstanding the pounding.

But the prospect of cutting down a small forest of sequoias for a pier is unappealing, not to mention cost-prohibitive, Wilson said.

Anyway, the supervisor said: "Even people who live there say it's a beautiful place without the pier."

Both Wilson and Bob Hamilton, the interim manager of county harbors, beaches and parks, said community interest in rebuilding the pier has declined and representatives say they prefer the beach as it is.

Kelly Nalley, 41, of Scottsdale, Ariz., remembers visiting the pier



The remnant of the Aliso Pier doesn't reach the ocean, and plans to rebuild the fishing pier, damaged by El Niño storms, are now in doubt.

every year with her family as a youngster. As much as she misses it, she admits she thought it was a little out of place.

After getting over the shock of seeing no pier, she concluded that it's "pretty nice to have the view unobstructed."

Aliso Pier was built in 1971 as the centerpiece of a 4.2-acre public beach development that included a parking lot off South Coast Highway.

The structure was one of the shorter and higher piers in Orange County. The deck rose 35 feet from the water, held up by dozens of concrete pilings with steel rods at their centers.

In 1983 and 1986, El Niño storms extensively damaged the pier. By 1987, the cracking concrete had become such a problem that the county closed the pier for more than two years and began a \$1.2-million reconstruction project.

But the 1997 storms caused the most damage. One-fourth of the pilings were cracked or damaged, and at least three had major problems with corrosion of exposed steel that had expanded and pushed out the concrete.

Initial estimates put the cost of rebuilding the pier at \$5 million, but some officials questioned whether the county had the money for such a project.

On a recent afternoon, feelings about rebuilding the pier were mixed.

"Now that it's gone it's really sad," said Debbie Monicatti, 52, of Aliso Viejo. "You don't have the opportunity to interact with the water, and a pier lets you do that if

you're not a surfer or a swimmer."

Surfers Sean Pettit, 24, of Mission Viejo and Marcus Hirth, 26, of San Clemente bemoaned the pier's demise as they stood on the beach

deciding if the waves were good enough to ride.

"[The pier] was great for surfing," Pettit said. "It was my favorite beach until they took away the



'Even people who live there say it's a beautiful place without the pier.'

TOM WILSON
Orange County Supervisor

pier."

And what's left of the pier—the building on the edge of the beach that houses the concession stand and restroom—may soon be removed as well.

The Federal Emergency Management Agency has rejected the county's request for funds for a new pier. But officials hope the agency will provide the \$400,000 to demolish the building and construct a new restroom and snack area.

If the county gets the money, the last piece of the original pier development will be history as well.

L.A. Then and Now / Cecilia Rasmussen

Woman's Lonely Saga Left a Mystery

The world knows of Ishi, ballyhooed as "the last wild California Indian" and the last of his Yahi tribe, who stumbled out of the wilderness into the gold mining town of Oroville in 1911.

But more than 50 years earlier, another sole survivor, the "Lone Woman" whom the priests named Juana Maria, was taken from the only home she had ever known and where she lived alone for 18 years—San Nicolas Island.

The mystery of her origins may be tied up with another and sadder story: the notorious massacre that wiped out most of the men of the island when she would have been a young child.

This wind-swept wilderness—one of two Channel Islands now under Navy control—was named for a saint, but it served as the setting for sinners, in the massacre of the Nicoleno tribe.

For thousands of years Nicolenos had scratched out a living on this 3-by-9-mile semidesert island, navigating its choppy waters in their canoes. These handsome natives lived peacefully for many generations—but the arrival of sea otter hunters at California's coast ended that.

In 1811, when Juana Maria would have been at least a toddler, hunters began scouring the California coast for the "soft gold" of extraordinarily lush otter pelts with a ruthlessness that almost brought the creatures to extinction. An American sea captain under contract to a Russian-American trading company had hired 30 fierce Kodiak Indians from Alaska to hunt otters. He dropped them off on remote San Nicolas Island.

The Kodiaks lost no time in slaughtering almost all of the native males and taking the women as slaves. And then the Kodiaks disappeared. History isn't clear on whether they simply left, or whether Nicoleno women avenged their husbands by killing the murderers as they slept.

Some scholars speculate that Juana Maria was younger than her contemporaries believed, and may have been the child of a forced coupling between a Kodiak man and a Nicoleno widow. Other historians believe that she arrived with her family sometime after the massacre, and was not a Nicoleno at all.

From the two songs and four words transcribed by Juana Maria's rescuer, Pamela Munro of UCLA's Department of Linguistics found that her language showed the influence of



Photo courtesy of Southwest Museum

Possible photo of Juana Maria, stranded on island for 18 years.

Alone on the island for 18 years, Juana Maria proved quite resourceful. She cast fishing lines with hooks made from shells. She built a hut of whale bones. She replaced her worn clothing with garments made from the feathers of cormorants.

the Luisenos of Northern San Diego County and of the Juanenos near San Juan Capistrano. Both traded with the American Indians of the Channel Islands.

By 1835, about 20 Nicolenos remained, Juana Maria among them. Unable to hold off Mexican and American forces or better-armed tribes, they were removed by the missionaries of Santa Barbara.

As they were boarding the schooner *Peor es Nada*, Juana Maria discovered her infant was missing and dived overboard. Ashore, she frantically searched for the baby basket she had fastened to a tree. Finding signs that her child had been eaten by wild dogs, she sat alone, weeping for days, near death.

Meanwhile, the other Nicolenos aboard ship were taken to Los Angeles, and most went to the San Gabriel Mission. A Nicoleno named Black Hawk, who had suffered a head injury during the massacre more than two decades earlier, moved in with some hunters at San Pedro. He soon

became blind, and fell from a steep bank and drowned.

Plans to rescue Juana Maria were put on hold while the *Peor es Nada* hauled lumber to San Francisco, where it capsized and sank. Ships were few and far between then, and interest in her rescue faded.

Alone on the island, Juana Maria proved quite resourceful. She cast fishing lines with hooks made from shells. She built a hut of whale bones. She replaced her worn clothing with garments made from the feathers of cormorants.

At night, she silently crept to the seams in cliff crags to snatch the sleeping birds from their roosts. She used a bone needle and threads made of seal sinews to sew their shiny green feathers together, carefully matching them so the finished garment looked to be made from solid material.

In 1850, 15 years after Juana Maria jumped ship, Father Gonzales of the Santa Barbara Mission paid shipowner Thomas Jeffries \$200 to find her. But Jeffries was more interested in the money, and his half-hearted attempt failed: he merely circled the island without touching land.

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Juana Maria's fondness for green corn, vegetables and fresh fruit caused severe attacks of dysentery. In her weakness, she fell from Nidever's porch and injured her spine.

On Oct. 18, 1853, only seven weeks after her arrival, she died. On her deathbed, she was christened Juana Maria. She was buried in the Nidever family plot at the Santa Barbara Mission cemetery. Nearly 75 years later, the Daughters of the American Revolution placed a plaque commemorating her.

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40 Horses Bolt From Burbank Corral, Run Through Streets

By SUE FOX
TIMES STAFF WRITER

Tempted by an open gate, 40 riding horses bolted from their Burbank corral Saturday morning and galloped through the streets, some hoofing it to a Glendale strip mall eight miles away, police said.

The frightened animals were cor-

ralled two hours later by more than a dozen Burbank and Glendale police officers, aided by residents using cars to block streets and cell phones to call in the latest sightings. No one was injured, although the escapee left a few horses with sore muscles, stable workers said.

The incident began just after 8 a.m. at the Circle K Riding Stables on Mariposa Street when the gate was left ajar, Burbank Police Sgt. Eric Rosoff said.

The recent rainy weather had apparently made the horses restless and eager for some exercise, said Erin McLaughlin, a Circle K worker. "They have a little more energy than usual. They're a little playful," she said. When they got out, "They were like, 'Wheeee! Let's go!' and they all went flying down the street."

The 911 calls poured in as the horses stampeded across Glendale, galloping down busy Alameda Avenue, San Fernando Road and Colorado Street.

Two horses trotted into someone's frontyard. A few always-prepared Boy Scouts managed to detain one just north of Glenoaks Boulevard. Seven horses wound up in a strip mall parking lot on the outskirts of Eagle Rock.

By midmorning, all of the escapees had been captured and returned to the stables. No property damage was reported, police said.

"Usually, it's one or two that get away. It's never been as many as this. . . . It was very scary. It was not amusing at all when it was happening," Rosoff said.

For the Record

Roosevelt's relative—Former President Franklin Delano Roosevelt was misidentified in the *Then and Now* column on March 11 as the great-great-grandson of California pioneer Henry Delano Fitch. Roosevelt was Fitch's third cousin, twice removed.

Lottery Results

For Saturday, March 17

SUPER LOTTO PLUS

Winning 5 Numbers
Plus MEGA number in bold
1-6-15-20-30—Mega 17
Jackpot: \$7 million
Xtra Reward Number:
11167802

FANTASY 5

Winning Numbers: 1-6-10-14-22

DAILY 3

Winning Numbers: 9-0-6

DAILY DERBY

Winning Horses:
(8) Gorgeous George
(7) Eureka
(3) Hot Shot
Race Time: 1:47.05
■ To win the grand prize, ticket holders must match, in exact order, the first, second- and third-place horses and the winning race time. Lesser prizes are given to ticket holders who match horses or the race time.

ON THE WEB

■ For lottery results on The Times' Web site, visit: www.latimes.com/edraas/lottery/

BY PHONE

■ General information only.
(Resumes not available at this time.)
(800) 588-6379

Woman's Lonely Saga Left a Mystery

The world knows of Ishi, ballyhooed as "the last wild California Indian" and the last of his Yahi tribe, who stumbled out of the wilderness into the gold mining town of Oroville in 1911. But more than 50 years earlier, another sole survivor, the "Lone Woman" whom the priests named Juana Maria, was taken from the only home she had ever known and where she lived alone for 18 years—San Nicolas Island.

The mystery of her origins may be tied up with another and sadder story: the notorious massacre that wiped out most of the men of the island when she would have been a young child.

This wind-swept wilderness—one of two Channel Islands now under Navy control—was named for a saint, but it served as the setting for sinners, in the massacre of the Nicolenos tribe.

For thousands of years Nicolenos had scratched out a living on this 3-by-9-mile semidesert island, navigating its choppy waters in their canoes. These handsome natives lived peacefully for many generations—but the arrival of sea otter hunters at California's coast ended that.

In 1811, when Juana Maria would have been at least a toddler, hunters began scouring the California coast for the "soft gold" of extraordinarily lush otter pelts with a ruthlessness that almost brought the creatures to extinction. An American sea captain under contract to a Russian-American trading company had hired 30 fierce Kodiak Indians from Alaska to hunt otters. He dropped them off on remote San Nicolas Island.

The Kodiaks lost no time in slaughtering almost all of the native males and taking the women as slaves. And then the Kodiaks disappeared. History isn't clear on whether they simply left, or whether Nicolenos women avenged their husbands by killing the murderers as they slept.

Some scholars speculate that Juana Maria was younger than her contemporaries believed, and may have been the child of a forced coupling between a Kodiak man and a Nicolenos widow. Other historians believe that she arrived with her family sometime after the massacre, and was not a Nicolenos at all.

From the two songs and four words transcribed by Juana Maria's rescuer, Pamela Munro of UCLA's Department of Linguistics found that her language showed the influence of



Photo courtesy of Southwest Museum

Possible photo of Juana Maria, stranded on island for 18 years.

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the Luisenos of Northern San Diego County and of the Juanenos near San Juan Capistrano. Both traded with the American Indians of the Channel Islands.

By 1835, about 20 Nicolenos remained, Juana Maria among them. Unable to hold off Mexican and American forces or better-armed tribes, they were removed by the missionaries of Santa Barbara.

As they were boarding the schooner *Peor* es Nada, Juana Maria discovered her infant was missing and dived overboard. Ashore, she frantically searched for the baby basket she had fastened to a tree. Finding signs that her child had been eaten by wild dogs, she sat alone, weeping for days, near death.

Meanwhile, the other Nicolenos aboard ship were taken to Los Angeles, and most went to the San Gabriel Mission. A Nicolenos named Black Hawk, who had suffered a head injury during the massacre more than two decades earlier, moved in with some hunters at San Pedro. He soon

became blind, and fell from a steep bank and drowned.

Plans to rescue Juana Maria were put on hold while the *Peor* es Nada hauled lumber to San Francisco, where it capsized and sank. Ships were few and far between then, and interest in her rescue faded.

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